Gray Alexander Collins

Ph.D. Student, Harvard Kennedy School

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Education

Ph.D., Public Policy, *Harvard University* 2026–present
Politics and Institutions track

A.B., Politics, *Princeton University* 2021
Certificates in African Studies and Ancient Roman Language and Culture

Research Interests

Comparative politics; political economy of development; African politics; urban politics; political behavior.

Research Experience

Pre-Doctoral Research Assistant, Harvard University 2025–2026
PIs: Gabriel Kreindler (Economics) and Carole Turley Voulgaris (Harvard Graduate School of Design)

Undergraduate Research Assistant, Princeton University 2019–2021
PI: Leonard Wantchekon (Politics and International Affairs)

Professional Experience

Research Analyst, Mathematica, Washington, DC 2022–2025

Internships Coordinator, Pace Center for Civic Engagement, Princeton University 2021–2022

Intern, Women's Microfinance Initiative, Buyobo, Uganda 2019

Intern, Peace Corps, Washington, DC 2018

Fellowships and Awards

Patricia "Pat" A. King Excellence in DEI Award, Mathematica ($1,500) 2024
In recognition of leadership and outstanding contributions to diversity and inclusion.

Dean's Fund for Summer Study Abroad, Princeton University ($4,500) 2020
Tuition and fees for Intermediate Swahili 1 & 2 at the African Flagship Languages Initiative (AFLI), University of Florida.

Class of 1978 Foundation Grant, Princeton University ($3,500) 2019
Supported a summer music program at Buyobo Primary School (Uganda), implemented in collaboration with Buyobo Women's Association. Funds covered instruments, dance costumes, instructor wages, and travel expenses.

John C. Bogle '51 Fellowship in Civic Service, Princeton University ($4,500) 2018

Quarterfinalist, Cornell Novice National Debating Championship 2018

Policy Reports

1. Meyer, Laura, Evan Borkum, and Gray Collins. 2024. "Impacts on Household Consumption for Cohort 1 of the Refugee Livelihoods Development Impact Bond." Mathematica, November.
2. Meyer, Laura, Evan Borkum, and Gray Collins. 2024. "Income-Generating Activities for Cohort 2 of the Refugee Livelihoods Development Impact Bond." Mathematica, August.
3. Pottinger, Emma, Katie Garland, Johanna Choumert Nkolo, Galina Lapadatova, Gray Collins, Sara Litke-Farzaneh, and So O'Neil. 2023. "Everyone Counts: Lessons about Collecting Gender Data to Improve Health Outcomes of the Transgender and Non-Binary Population for the U.S. Census Bureau and Other Population-Based Survey Instruments." Mathematica, December.
4. Meyer, Laura, Evan Borkum, and Gray Collins. 2023. "Income-Generating Activities for Cohort 1 of the Refugee Livelihoods Development Impact Bond." Mathematica, September.

Other Information

Languages Swahili (intermediate), French (beginner), Latin

Software R, Stata, SurveyCTO, Survey Solutions, GitHub

Citizenship United States